

Confusing Words: Contextual Usage of Chinese Verbs Through Cognitive Linguistics

คำศัพท์ที่สับสนง่าย: บริบทการใช้คำกริยาภาษาจีนผ่านภาษาศาสตร์ปริชาน

Nititaya Soontornthamniti

นิธิตยา สุนทรธรรมนิติ

Faculty of Liberal Arts, Prince of Songkla University, Thailand

Corresponding author

e-mail: nititaya.s@gmail.com

Received 27-09-2025**Revised** 03-12-2025**Accepted** 13-12-2025**Doi:** 10.69598/artssu.2026.5800.**How to Cite:**

Soontornthamniti, N. (2026).
Confusing Words: Contextual
Usage of Chinese Verbs
Through Cognitive Linguistics.
Journal of Arts and Thai Studies,
48(1), E5800 (1-21).

Keywords: Chinese confusing
words, contextual usage,
cognitive linguistics, image
schema

คำสำคัญ: คำศัพท์ภาษาจีนที่
สับสนง่าย, การใช้ในบริบท,
ภาษาศาสตร์ปริชาน, ภาพร่าง

Abstract

Background and Objectives: In the process of second language (L2) acquisition, word pairs that L2 learners often feel confused about are called “confusing words (A word easily confused with another because of similar meaning, alphabet, pronunciation, or translation)”. Among Thais studying Chinese as a foreign language (CFL), confusion usually emerges in the use of the five Chinese verbs: ‘Gei (给)’, ‘Jiao (叫)’, ‘Qing (请)’, ‘Rang (让)’, and ‘Shi (使)’. This research aims to examine the contextual usage of these five verbs, especially in cases of semantic overlap, with the research question, “How do Chinese verbs with shared meanings differ in their contextual usage?”

Methods: This research article employed a qualitative research approach. Data were collected from books, dictionaries, and Chinese proficiency test (HSK) materials. The analysis was grounded in cognitive linguistics framework, including image schema theory and idealized cognitive models (ICMs).

Results: The findings reveal that from the five semantically related verbs, verbs expressing “causing someone do something” commonly occur in general and service-related contexts, while those denoting “permission” are primarily found in workplace and medical settings. The meanings of “causation” and “invitation” are more broadly applicable in general contexts. Moreover, the ICMs-based analysis identified four schematic sentence structures that reflect underlying conceptual representations.

Application of this study: This research contributes to a better understanding and accurate use of easily confusable Chinese vocabulary among learners and teachers of Chinese as a foreign language. Teachers can apply the findings as instructional strategies, while learners can use them to further develop their communicative competence. Emphasizing appropriate contextual usage, the application of image-schema-based concepts helps learners better comprehend and acquire the contextual meanings and uses of vocabulary.

Conclusions: The result indicate that the Chinese verbs have a shared meaning and are grouped under the same semantic category, but some of those words have different schematic usage structures. This study found that some words can be used in the same contexts and situations, but they might emphasize different orientations. The theoretical significance of this research article is that using schema theory and ICMs to analyze contextual usage of words, can be helpful to clearly visualize sentence structures by highlighting the prominence and focal points.

บทคัดย่อ

ที่มาและวัตถุประสงค์: ในกระบวนการรับรู้ภาษาที่สอง (L2) คู่คำที่ผู้เรียนภาษาที่สองมักสับสนเรียกว่า “คำศัพท์ที่สับสนง่าย (คำศัพท์ที่สับสนกับคำอื่นได้ง่ายเพราะมีความหมาย ตัวอักษร เสียง หรือคำแปลคล้ายคลึงกัน)” โดยกลุ่มผู้เรียนชาวไทยที่เรียนภาษาจีนเป็นภาษาต่างประเทศ (CFL) มักสับสนระหว่างการใช้คำกริยา 5 คำ ได้แก่ ‘Gei (给)’ ‘Jiao (叫)’ ‘Qing (请)’ ‘Rang (让)’ และ ‘Shi (使)’ บทความวิจัยฉบับนี้จึงมีวัตถุประสงค์เพื่อศึกษาบริบทการใช้คำกริยา 5 คำ โดยเจาะจงความหมายของคำศัพท์ที่มีความสัมพันธ์ทับซ้อนกัน ภายใต้คำถามวิจัยว่า คำศัพท์ที่มีความหมายสัมพันธ์กันมีบริบทการใช้แตกต่างกันอย่างไร

วิธีการศึกษา: บทความวิจัยฉบับนี้เป็นงานวิจัยเชิงคุณภาพ รวบรวมข้อมูลจากหนังสือ พจนานุกรม และหนังสือรวบรวมข้อสอบวัดระดับความรู้ภาษาจีน (HSK) วิเคราะห์ภายใต้กรอบแนวคิดไวยากรณ์ปริชาน ประกอบด้วย ภาพร่างและแบบจำลองความคิด (ICMs)

ผลการศึกษา: ผลการศึกษาพบว่าคำกริยาทั้ง 5 คำที่มีความหมายสัมพันธ์กันทางด้านความหมาย ได้แก่ ให้ทำ อนุญาต ทำให้เกิด และเชิญ มีบริบทการใช้ที่เหมือนและแตกต่างกัน คำกริยาที่หมายถึง “ให้ทำ” มักใช้ในบริบททั่วไป และในบริบท

ที่เกี่ยวกับการบริการ ในขณะที่คำที่หมายถึง “อนุญาต” มักใช้ในบริบทการทำงาน และการรักษาทางการแพทย์เป็นหลัก ส่วนคำที่หมายถึง “ทำให้เกิด” และ “เชิญ” มักใช้ในบริบททั่วไปที่มีขอบเขตกว้างกว่า นอกจากนี้ยังพบว่าการวิเคราะห์ภายใต้แบบจำลองความคิด (ICMs) แสดงให้เห็นผังภาพโครงสร้างประโยคทั้งหมด 4 รูปแบบ ที่สามารถสะท้อนให้เห็นโครงสร้างเชิงมนทัศน์ที่อยู่เบื้องหลังของภาษา

การประยุกต์ใช้: การวิจัยนี้ช่วยให้ผู้เรียนและผู้สอนภาษาจีนในฐานะภาษาต่างประเทศเข้าใจและใช้คำศัพท์ภาษาจีนที่สับสนง่ายได้ถูกต้อง โดยผู้สอนสามารถนำไปใช้เป็นกลยุทธ์ในการสอน ในขณะที่ผู้เรียนสามารถนำไปพัฒนาทักษะการสื่อสารได้เช่นกัน ซึ่งเน้นย้ำการใช้ในบริบทที่เหมาะสม โดยใช้แนวคิดภาพร่างจะช่วยให้ผู้เรียนเข้าใจและเรียนรู้บริบทการใช้คำศัพท์ได้ดียิ่งขึ้น

บทสรุป: ผลการศึกษาชี้ให้เห็นว่าคำกริยาภาษาจีนที่มีความหมายสัมพันธ์กัน และจัดอยู่ในกลุ่มอรรถศาสตร์เดียวกัน คำศัพท์บางคำมีภาพโครงสร้างประโยคที่แตกต่างกัน ซึ่งผลการศึกษาพบว่าคำศัพท์บางคำเน้นต่างกัน แต่สามารถใช้ในบริบทและสถานการณ์เดียวกันได้ ซึ่งความสำคัญทางด้านทฤษฎีของบทความวิจัยฉบับนี้คือ การใช้ทฤษฎีภาพร่าง ICMs ในการวิเคราะห์บริบทการใช้คำศัพท์สามารถช่วยให้จินตนาการโครงสร้างประโยคได้ชัดเจนขึ้น โดยการเน้นย้ำจุดเด่น และจุดสนใจ

Introduction

In the process of Chinese language acquisition, confusing words (word pairs or groups that learners often confuse) (Zhang, 2008) have become a common phenomenon among CFL learners. They frequently mistake certain words for another, misunderstanding A as B when trying to comprehend A.

Research on this phenomenon is continuously being conducted. However, existing publications mainly focus on error analysis of the CFL learners' use of Chinese words, particularly in relation to the influence of their native language backgrounds, such as Indonesian, Thai, and Korean (Zhang, 2016; Xiao, 2008; Lai, 2018). The research underlines the cause of the confusion, and further recommends tactics and strategies for more effective Chinese language teaching and learning.

Cognitive linguistics assumes that grammar is inherently meaningful, the lexical and grammatical items reside on a continuum of meaning from specific to schematic, and that all linguistic structures are instantiated as parts of the idealized cognitive model (ICMs) (Lakoff, 1988). Cognitive grammar stresses that grammatical structure is closely related with meaning or stimulated by meaning, not only at word level, but also in the constructions of more complex language units. So, words are a fundamental of grammar (Arunmanakul, 2020). In the studies of polysemy, semantic change, grammaticalization, and image schema, theory plays an important role. Such theories have also been utilized in literary and textual analysis (Oakley, 2012).

Cognitive metaphor theory has also been used in several studies to explain Chinese spatial and temporal concepts, such as the metaphoric uses of qian (‘前’), hou (‘后’) (Urapeepatanapong, 2024), and Northern Thai dialects' use of metaphorical words for time (Ampala, 2016). These studies suggest that word use can be acquired through imagery and gives a full picture of how words are used in context. Instruction based on conceptual metaphors significantly improves understanding and retention. The use of contextual analysis in teaching vocabulary can help students find out the meaning of unfamiliar or difficult words when reading (Samita, Supardi, & Husin, 2015 : 8). The meaning of a sentence often relies on the nuanced interplay of words and their contextual relationships. Words often have multiple meanings, and their interpretations depend on the surrounding context (Johnwick, 2024).

Results of the exercises by Soontornthamni (2024). showed students tend to get mixed up with the verbs ‘gei (给)’ and ‘rang (让)’. Both words were more inclined to be translated to ‘hai (ให้)’ in Thai, which can mean ‘to give’, ‘for’, ‘to’, or ‘let’, depending on the context. Thus, students frequently questioned the differences between the two words. For

example, in the sentence 'Mother asked me to go buy something. (妈妈让我去买东西。), some students confused 'gei (给)' as 'rang (让)'. Using them interchangeably would alter the meaning and thus highlights the need for contextual analysis. Similar findings were also given to other verbs such as 'jiao (叫)', meaning 'to call', and 'qing (请)', meaning 'please'.

Soontornthamniti (2024) conducted a semantic analysis of five Chinese verbs: 'gei (给)', 'jiao (叫)', 'qing (请)', 'rang (让)', and 'shi (使)'. She identified that the verbs share four fundamental meanings: 1) to make someone do something, 2) to allow, 3) to bring about a result, and 4) to invite. The study gave emphasis on the importance of pragmatic ability in acquiring a language and investigating the use of words in society in context as a valuable area of research. Considering these previous findings, the present study aims to explore the contextual dimension of word usage to add another perspective and complement previous research. A contrastive analysis of the grammatical and pragmatic applications of these verbs should be beneficial to both pedagogical practice and learners' communicational skills.

This present study aims to analyze the contextual usage of five Chinese verbs ('gei (给)' 'jiao (叫)' 'qing (请)' 'rang (让)' 'shi (使)') that are semantically related through cognitive linguistics and its framework of image schema. As a fundamental cognitive structure, the image schema provides a systematic analytical lens that clarifies subtle semantic distinctions and enhances understanding at the sentence level. This study addresses the following research question: *How do Chinese verbs with shared meanings differ in their contextual usage?* The findings are expected to benefit not only CFL instructors but also learners.

Research Objectives

This study aims to analyze the contextual usage of five Chinese verbs ('gei (给)' 'jiao (叫)' 'qing (请)' 'rang (让)' 'shi (使)') that are semantically related through cognitive linguistics and image schema.

Literature Review

1. Image Schema Theory

Image schema theory is a basic structure of cognitive process used to explain the complex structure. In 1987, Lakoff proposes ideas on ICMs, which explains the complex structure in a systematic way. The five types of ICMs are 1) propositional ICMs, which consist of basic elements related to situation; 2) image schematic ICMs, which show the structure to explain concepts, and relies on object position, shape, and path of movement; 3) metaphoric mappings, which occur when transferring a certain object to another position; 4) metonymic mappings, which adapt a concept instead of another; and 5) symbolic ICMs, which explain the knowledge of language (Lakoff, 1987). Image schema serves as a foundation for understanding conceptual thinking processes that regulate learning and usage within a society. Moreover, the cognitive processes that enable learners to understand the word form or sentence structure result from the relationship with the conceptual structures that learners form to enhance comprehension by using past perceptual experiences as a foundation for language learning (Tangpakorn, 2018).

Image schema theory is the basic structure of cognitive process that uses body or sensory perception to perceive and understand past perceptual experiences. The theory serves as a foundation for constructing subsequent meaning, and for understanding complex concepts. In linguistics field, cognitive grammar cannot be separated from lexicon or syntax, and there is no clear boundary between the lexicon and grammar. Cognitive grammar attempts to prove that

grammatical structure is associated with meaning or stimulated by meaning, not only the meaning of word level, but also the meaning of words from the construction of more complex language units. So, words are a fundamental of grammar. One cognitive process can be used for word level or more (Arunmanakul, 2020).

2. Schema and Language Study

The study of the polysemous term 'qi (起)' in Mandarin Chinese—whose meaning encompasses human bodily experiences of motion, the movement of objects, and conceptualizations of time and quantity—identified five meanings of 'qi (起)' in fictive motion events. One of these meaning represents a path conceptualized as a straight vertical line with departure vector, in which the figure is above the ground and receives anchoring attention (Sirisumpan & Saralamba, 2021). Employing the image schema approach, some research used cognitive metaphor theory to explain the spatial concepts and time metaphors 'qian (前)' (front), and 'hou (后)' (back) in actual usage in Mandarin Chinese and Thai language. The research focused on similarities and differences between 'qian (前)' and 'hou (后)' in Mandarin Chinese, and 'na (หน้า)' (front) and 'lang (หลัง)' (back) in Thai. These spatial terms can express different meanings depending on their position and perspective. The researcher proposes a new analytical approach: if the 'observer' is treated as the reference point and movement is conceptualized as proceeding forward in the observer's direction, different image schemas can be used to explain the distribution of 'front' and 'back' in the two languages (Urapeepatanapong, 2024). From more comprehensive exploration, similarities and differences between the word 'kanwang (看望)' (visiting) and 'fangwen (访问)' (calling) in Chinese are based on native speaker corpora. These two words are commonly employed in scenarios like business transactions, political diplomacy, cultural education, and daily communication. There are similarities and differences in how target words function in relation to other sentence elements (Zhang, 2024).

From the literature review, the use of image schemas to compare differences between Chinese words clearly demonstrates their distinctions within the framework of cognitive linguistics. In contrast, prior research focused on a pair of words with similar meanings. Research exploring the complex relationships among word categories that share similar meanings, particularly Chinese word categories in terms of contextual usage, remains limited, even though such research could help learners use vocabulary more appropriately in context.

Therefore, this study incorporates multiple perspectives and analytical approaches to address such a research gap by exploring how semantically related Chinese words differ in their contextual usage. The research framework is presented in Figure 1.

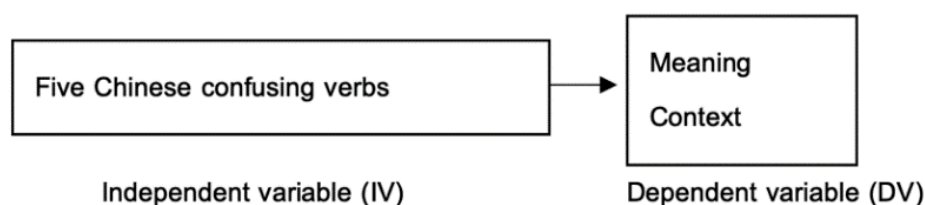


Figure 1 Research Framework
(Source: Soontornthamni, 2025a)

Research Methods

1. Scope of the Research

This study focusses on five Chinese verbs, including 'gei (给)' 'jiao (叫)' 'qing (请)' 'rang (让)' 'shi (使)', which are in the same category of shared meaning: causing someone to do something, granting permission, causation, and invitation (Soontornthamniti, 2024). However, this study investigated the issue within the dimension of contextual word usage, which used in the pivotal sentences, with the structure of "S + V1 + NP (兼语) + V2". The sources of this present study were (1) a book and a dictionary: *Contemporary Chinese Dictionary (7th Edition)* (Institute of linguistics, 2021); and (2) official examination papers from the Chinese Proficiency Test (HSK) (Confucius Institute Headquarters (Hanban), 2018a; 2018b; 2018c; 2018d; 2019a; 2019b), specifically the 2018 test series for levels 1–6. The selection was based on reliability, standardization, and updated content (Soontornthamniti, 2024).

2. Data Collection

This research employed a qualitative approach. Data were collected by exploring the usage and grammatical patterns of five Chinese verbs with shared meanings, compiling sentences and phrases containing these verbs from HSK examination papers, and verifying the accuracy of the data prior to analysis.

2.1 Criteria for Data Selection

The criteria for data selection included:

- 1) selecting five Chinese words, 'gei (给)' 'jiao (叫)' 'qing (请)' 'rang (让)' 'shi (使)', functioning as verbs.
- 2) selecting sentences from HSK exam papers, excluding test questions, and duplicate sentences.
- 3) selecting words, which are not compounding, such as shenqingbiao (申请表), shenqing (申请), shide (使得), shiming (使命), jiyu (给予), qingjia (请假), and qingwen (请问).

3. Data Analysis

3.1 Abbreviations and Acronyms

- 1)  Trajector, a not clearly defined moving object.
- 2)  Landmark, a clearly specified destination.
- 3)  Path, a path or direction that moves horizontally in a straight line toward a clearly defined motions of objects.

3.2 Analytical Procedure

This study utilized descriptive analysis, using cognitive linguistics to analyze the data through comparative approach, to study contextual usage of the five Chinese verbs. Such contextual usage of the verbs used in sentences was analyzed using image schema theory. It was done to generate a model following the ICMs concept.

Analytical procedure: (1) Categorization: classify the sentences based on their structural features and semantic context; (2) Schematic Analysis: analyze the conceptual foundations and identify the essential components of each sentence; (3) Image Schema Mapping: apply the derived structures to compare with image schema; (4) Comparative Analysis and Model Generation: comparative image schema of five Chinese verbs, in order to identify commonalities and differences.

The following figure (Figure 2) presents the flow of the research:

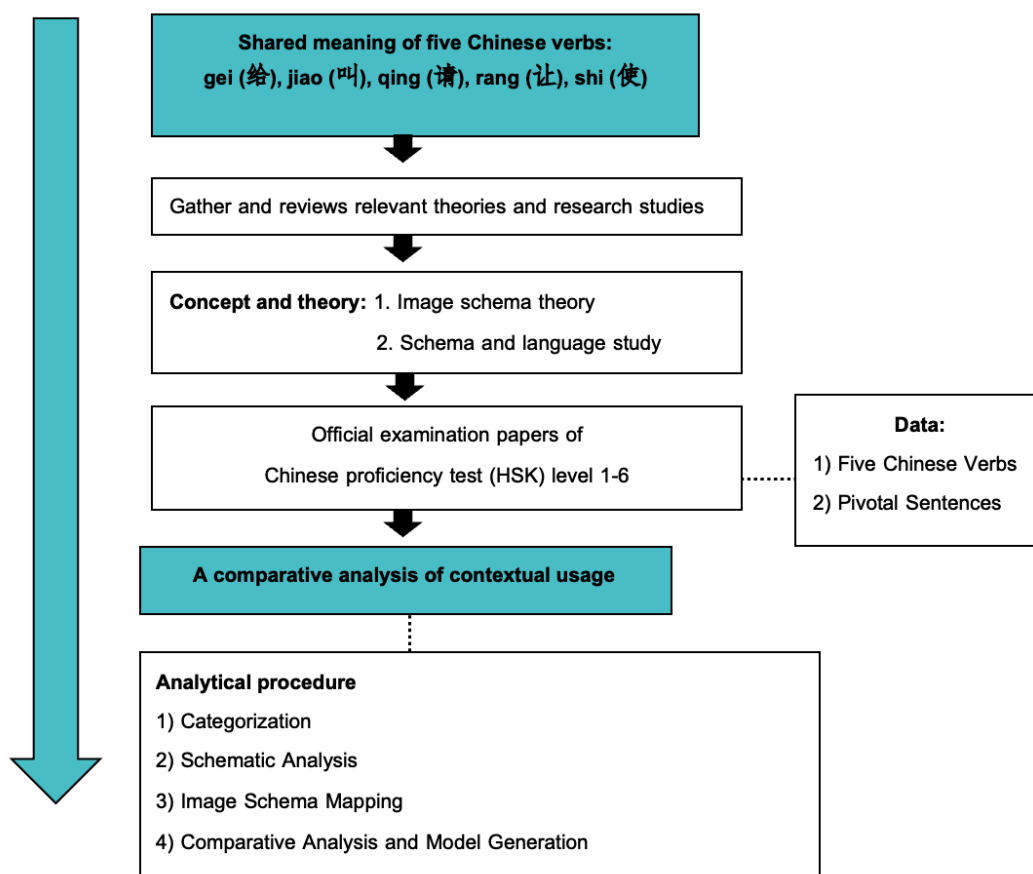


Figure 2 Research Flow

(Source: Soontornthamnit, 2025b)

Research Results

The contextual usage of five Chinese verbs, 'gei(给)' 'jiao(叫)' 'qing(请)' 'rang(让)' and 'shi(使)', with semantically related meaning was divided into four aspects. Using image schema theory of cognitive linguistics, a model adhering to ICMs concept was generated in each shared meaning. The results from the analysis are presented as follows.

1. The Contextual Usage of Verbs With 'Causing Someone to do Something' Meaning

The contextual usage of verbs with the meaning of 'causing someone to do something' comprises 'gei (给)' 'jiao (叫)' 'qing (请)' 'rang (让)' and 'shi (使)'.

Table 1 Contextual Usage of Verbs With 'Causing Someone to do Something' Meaning

Context of Use	Vocabulary				
	gei (给)	jiao (叫)	qing (请)	rang (让)	shi (使)
1. General	+	+	+	+	+
2. Service	-	+	+	-	-
3. Politely request	-	-	+	-	-
4. Assignment	-	-	-	-	+

As seen from Table 1, although the words could be used in a general context, they each emphasize different nuances in meaning. Among the terms, 'Qing (请)' was used in more formal and polite contexts compared to the other words. 'Shi (使)' was used in assignment.

1.1 Gei (给) is commonly used in general context focusing on making someone do something, which can be people or animals, such as to make animal eat or drink. For example:

[1] 男：这是什么药？女：给小狗吃，它这两天不吃东西，也不喝水。

(Man: What kind of medicine is this? Woman: Give (something) to the puppy to eat. It hasn't eaten or drunk anything for the past two days.)

(Confucius Institute Headquarters (Hanban), 2018b)

[2] 给小猫喝点儿牛奶吧！

(Let the cat drink some milk!)

(Confucius Institute Headquarters (Hanban), 2018b)

1.2 Jiao (叫) is commonly used in general and service context, focusing on telling someone what to do by 'call' someone to do, and ordering in the context of service. For example:

[3] 他现在正在洗澡，叫我们先吃饭，不用等他。

(He's taking a shower right now. He told us to go ahead and eat without waiting for him.)

(Confucius Institute Headquarters (Hanban), 2019a)

1.3 Qing (请) is used in general and service context. It focuses on polite requests and is used in formal language. Within service context, the usage often pertains to aviation and business.

1.3.1 General: politely request, kindly request or notify someone to perform an action, often used in formal language, for example:

[4] 请把这些报纸按时间顺序排列好。

(Please arrange these newspapers in chronological order.)

(Confucius Institute Headquarters (Hanban), 2018c)

[5] 报名时间已经截止，请已报名的同学随时关注我们的网站……。

(The application period has ended. Students who have already applied are kindly requested to regularly check our website.)

(Confucius Institute Headquarters (Hanban), 2019b)

1.3.2 Service is used in aviation and business service contexts, as described below: [8]-[9] is aviation service, and [10] is general service.

[6] 麻烦您打开，我们要检查一下。另外，请给我看一下您的护照和登机牌。

(Could you please open it? We need to check it. Also, may we see your passport and ticket, please?)

(Confucius Institute Headquarters (Hanban), 2018c)

[7] 先生，飞机马上就要起飞了，请您回座位上坐好。

(Sir, the airplane will take off soon, please return to your seat and fasten your seatbelt.)

(Confucius Institute Headquarters (Hanban), 2018c)

[8] 这种商品暂时缺货，方便的话，请留下您的姓名和电话，一有货我就通知您。

(This item is temporarily out of stock. If it's convenient, please leave your name and phone number, and I will contact you once it becomes available.)

(Confucius Institute Headquarters (Hanban), 2019b)

1.4 Rang (让) is used in general contexts, typically in a form of commands by individuals with higher authority, such as seniors or medical professionals. For example:

1.4.1 Order in the context related to 'people' 'plant'

[9] 这种教育其实是失败的，父母应该多给孩子留些时间，让他们去做喜欢的事情。

(This kind of education is actually a failure. Parents should spend more time with their children and let them do what they love.)

(Confucius Institute Headquarters (Hanban), 2018c)

[10] 报纸上说，轻松、活泼的音乐可以让植物长得更快，例如，每天让西红柿“听”三个小时这样的音乐，它们竟然可以长到一公斤重。

(The newspaper reported that cheerful and relaxing music can help plants grow faster. For example, let tomatoes 'listen' to this kind of music for 3 hours every day, they actually grew to weigh up to 1 kilogram.)

(Confucius Institute Headquarters (Hanban), 2018c)

[11] 我已经跟室友打过招呼了，到时候让他帮忙照顾一下。

(I have already told my roommate, let him help take care of it when the time comes.)

(Confucius Institute Headquarters (Hanban), 2018d)

1.4.2 Order in the context between teacher and student, and sibling relationship.

[12] 上课前，老师让同学们每人拿出一张纸，写上自己的座位号。

(Before the class starts, the teacher told the students to take a sheet of paper and write down their seat number.)

(Confucius Institute Headquarters (Hanban), 2018d)

[13] 他让姐姐问员工。

(He asked his older sister to ask the staff.)

(Confucius Institute Headquarters (Hanban), 2018b)

[14] 李阿姨想让小亮表示感谢。

(Aunt Li wants Xiao Liang to express his gratitude.)

(Confucius Institute Headquarters (Hanban), 2019b)

1.4.3 Prescribed by a doctor

[15] 男：我这几天咳嗽有点儿严重，大夫让我少抽烟。

(Male: For the past 2-3 days, I've been coughing a lot. The doctor told me to smoke less.)

(Confucius Institute Headquarters (Hanban), 2018c)

1.5 Shi (使) is used in general contexts, focusing on assignment to do somethings not specific. For example:

[16] 使人去打听消息。

(Send someone to inquire about the information.)

(Institute of Linguistics, 2021)

Seen from the above examples, the schematic structure analysis of the usage revealed three types of visual schematics, as follows:

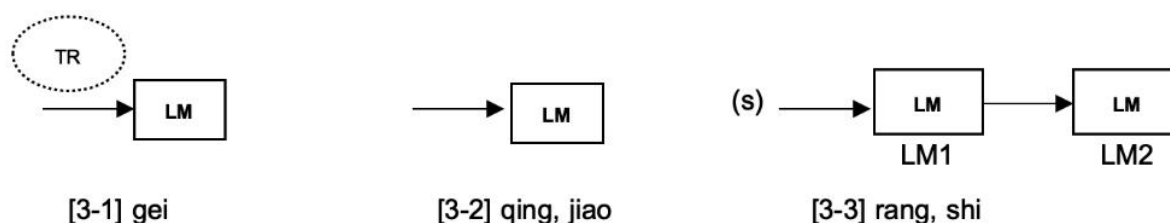


Figure 3 Image Schema of Verbs With "Causing Someone to Do Something" Meaning

(Source: Soontornthamnit, 2025c)

From the Figure 3, [3-1] shows the path that moves horizontally in a straight line toward objects LM. TR is a trajector which is not clearly defined as moving object. But, [3-2] [3-3] do not have TR. [3-3] shows that there are two LM, and the syntactic subject can be omitted, but [3-1] and [3-2] beginning a sentence without a subject is possible in certain contexts.

For example, [1] 男：这是什么药？女：给小狗吃，它这两天不吃东西，也不喝水。(Man: What kind of medicine is this? Woman: Give (something) to the puppy to eat. It hasn't eaten or drunk anything for the past two days.). In this sentence, '小狗吃 (the puppy to eat)' is LM, and '药(medicine)' is TR, which is not clearly defined in sentence. [4] 请把这些报纸按时间顺序排列好。(Please arrange these newspapers in chronological order.). In this sentence, '把这些报纸按时间顺序排列好 (arrange these newspapers in chronological order.)' is LM. Notably, the sentence has no explicit subject. [12] 上课前老师让同学们每人拿出一张纸，写上自己的座位号。(Before the class starts, the teacher told the students to take a sheet of paper and write down their seat number.). In this sentence, '同学们每人拿出一张纸 (the students to take a sheet of paper)' functions as LM1 (LM1 is the first landmark in the sentence), and '写上自己的座位号。(write down their seat number)' functions as LM2 (LM2 is the second landmark in the sentence). The subject is '老师 (the teacher)', the object of the first verb phrase is '同学们

(student)', which is also serves as subject of the second verb phrase. Moreover, the syntactic subject can be omitted in some sentences, such as in [16] 使人去打听消息。

2. The Contextual Usage of Verbs With 'Granting Permission' Meaning

The contextual usage of verbs with the meaning of 'granting permission' comprises 'gei (给)' 'jiao (叫)' 'rang (让)'.

Table 2 Contextual Usage of Verbs With "Granting Permission" Meaning

Context of Use	Vocabulary				
	gei (给)	jiao (叫)	qing (请)	rang (让)	shi (使)
1. General	-	+	+	-	+
2. Work leave	+	-	-	+	-
3. To rest	+	-	-	+	-
4. Promotion	-	-	+	-	-
5. Medical Treatment	-	-	+	-	-

As seen from Table 2, 'jiao (叫)' and 'rang (让)' can be used in general texts, and 'gei (给)' is specifically used in two contexts: work leave and rest. In addition, the contextual usage of the word 'rang (让)' is broader than that of the other words.

2.1 Gei (给) is used in permission to leave and to rest. It can be used to allow both others and oneself to do the same.

[17] 给女的放几天假。

(Grant the woman a few days' leave.)

(Confucius Institute Headquarters (Hanban), 2018d)

[18] 慢慢地我发现，做自己感兴趣的事情，不去想结果，偶尔给自己放个假，这才是真正积极健康的生活态度。

(I gradually realized that doing what I'm interested in without worrying about the outcomes, and allowing myself to take some time off work occasionally, is what truly makes for a healthy lifestyle.)

(Confucius Institute Headquarters (Hanban), 2018c)

2.2 Jiao (叫) is used in a general context. It means *allow to do* which focuses on 'call'.

[19] 他不叫去，我偏要去。

(Even if he doesn't (allow) me to go, I will go anyway.)

(Institute of Linguistics, 2021)

2.3 Rang (让) is predominantly used in work and medical treatment contexts. Below are the details:

2.3.1 General: permission to do something, for example:

[20] 男：报纸上介绍的这个人，是我的朋友。女：真的吗？快让我看看！

(Male: The person recommended in the newspaper is my friend. Female: Really? Quick, let me see!)

(Confucius Institute Headquarters (Hanban), 2018b)

[21] 如果您要出去一段时间，请让我们来照顾您的小狗吧。

(If you are going to be away for a while, please let us take care of your dog.)

(Confucius Institute Headquarters (Hanban), 2019a)

2.3.2 Promotion: grant permission for promotion, for example:

[22] 对，不过因为他表现出色，领导很看好他，所以决定让他提前转正。

(Yes, but because he performed outstandingly, the boss was very satisfied with him, so he decided to approve his early promotion.)

(Confucius Institute Headquarters (Hanban), 2018d)

2.3.3 Medical treatment: permission or refusal granted by a medical doctor, focusing on dietary permission, for example:

[23] 男：喝咖啡吗？女：医生不让我喝，给我杯牛奶吧。

(Male: Would you like some coffee? Female: The doctor didn't allow me to drink it. Give me a glass of milk instead.)

(Confucius Institute Headquarters (Hanban), 2018b)

The schematic structure analysis of usage reveals three types of visual schematics as follows:

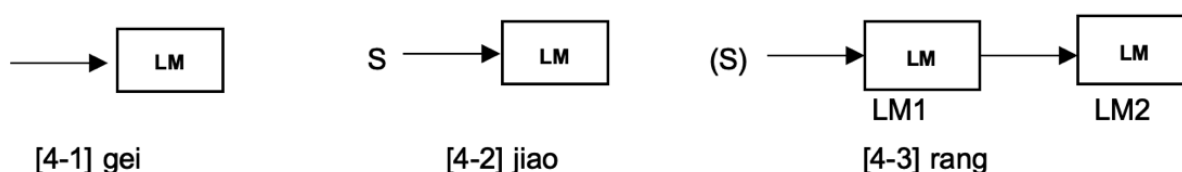


Figure 4 Image Schema of Verbs With "Granting Permission" Meaning

(Source: Soontornthamni, 2025d)

From Figure 4, [4-1], and [4-2] show the path that moves horizontally in a straight line toward objects LM, [4-1] without a subject, [4-2] with subject. In addition, [4-3] shows that there are two of LM, and the syntactic subject can be omitted.

For example, [17] 给女的放几天假。(Grant the woman a few days' leave.) In this sentence, '放几天假 (a few days' leave)' is LM. This sentence is without a subject, 'gei (给)' and is followed by personal object, which is '女(woman)'. [19] 他不叫去，我偏要去。(Even if he doesn't (allow) me to go, I will go anyway.). In this sentence, '他(he)' functions as the subject (S), and the object of first verb phrase is '我(me)', which also serves as the subject of second verb phrase. Moreover, '去(go)' is LM of the sentence. [23] 男：喝咖啡吗？女：医生不让我喝，

给我杯牛奶吧。(Male: Would you like some coffee? Female: The doctor didn't allow me to drink it. Give me a glass of milk instead.). In this sentence, '医生不让我喝(the doctor didn't allow me to drink)' is LM1, and '我不喝咖啡(I don't drink coffee)' is LM2. '医生 (doctor)' functions as the subject (S). The object of first verb phrase is '我 (me)', which also serves as the subject of second verb phrase.

3. The Contextual Usage of Verbs With 'Causation' Meaning

The contextual usage of verbs with the meaning of 'causation, includes 'rang(让)' and 'shi(使)'.

Table 3 Contextual Usage of Verbs With "Causation" Meaning

Context of Use	Vocabulary	
	Rang (让)	Shi (使)
1. General		
1.1 Clearly and concretely defined	+	-
1.2 Comply with regulations	-	+
1.3 Recognize the value	-	+
2. Emotion (Positive and Negative)	+	+
3. Change (Positive; Negative; neutral)	-	+

As can be seen from Table 3, 'rang (让)' and 'shi (使)' both can be used in a general context, but with different focuses. The contextual usage of 'Shi(使)' is broader than others. This term is applicable not only in the context of 'emotional' but also extends to that of 'change'.

3.1 Rang (让) is applied in general contexts to indicate 1) causing outcomes that are clearly and concretely defined; and 2) emotion (both positive and negative).

3.1.1 Causing outcomes that are clearly and concretely defined, such as health, knowledge, and movement.

[24] 为了让自己更健康，他每天都花了一个小时去锻炼身体。

(To make himself stronger, he spends one hour every day exercising.)

(Confucius Institute Headquarters (Hanban), 2019a)

[25] 父亲对我说，写给儿童的故事不一定要有多美的语言，但一定要有好的内容，那些能让孩子学到知识的故事才是真正的好故事。

(My father told me that stories written for children don't need to use very beautiful language, but they must have good content. A truly good story is one that can help children gain knowledge.)

(Confucius Institute Headquarters (Hanban), 2018c)

[26] 高提水壶，利用手腕的力量，上下提拉注水，让茶叶在水中翻动，如此反复三次。

(Hold the teapot high and use wrist strength to pour the water up and down, causing the tea leaves to swirl in the water. Repeat this process three times.)

(Confucius Institute Headquarters (Hanban), 2019b)

3.1.2 Emotion is used in the context that emphasizes eliciting emotional responses, including both positive and negative emotional.

3.1.2.1 Positive emotional responses, include excitement, surprise, relaxation, satisfaction, happiness, and feeling touched.

[27] 李教授的突然出现让大家很激动。

(The sudden appearance of Professor Li made everyone very excited.)

(Confucius Institute Headquarters (Hanban), 2018c)

[28] 因为有氧运动能促进脑内产生一种愉悦感，这种愉悦感能够让人释放压力，减少负面情绪。

(Because aerobic exercise can stimulate a certain kind of pleasure in the brain, this sense of enjoyment can help reduce stress and decrease negative emotions.)

(Confucius Institute Headquarters (Hanban), 2018d)

[29] 我认为快乐其实很简单，有时一声谢谢、一个笑脸，或者一件小小的礼物，都能让我觉得快乐。

(I think that, in fact, being happy is quite simple. Sometimes, a word of thanks, a smile, or even a small gift can make me feel happy.)

(Confucius Institute Headquarters (Hanban), 2019a)

[30] 弟弟平时成绩很一般，但没想到他竟然考上了一个很不错的大学，这个消息让我们一家人都非常开心。

(My younger brother usually gets average scores, but unexpectedly, he got accepted into a pretty good university. This news made our whole family very happy.)

(Confucius Institute Headquarters (Hanban), 2018c)

[31] 这样的拍摄方式显然让人们收获更多的乐趣。

(Taking photos like this clearly makes people enjoy themselves even more.)

(Confucius Institute Headquarters (Hanban), 2019b)

3.1.2.2 Negative emotional responses, includes feelings of being unbearable, fear, disappointment and pain.

[32] 一个寒假没住，房间里的味道实在让人受不了。

(It's not the winter holiday season, but the smell in the room makes people unable to stand it.)

(Confucius Institute Headquarters (Hanban), 2018c)

[33] 在那里除了风吹动树叶的沙沙声以外，几乎听不到任何动物的声音，安静得让人害怕。

(There, besides the sound of leaves rustling in the wind, you can hardly hear any animal sounds. It's so quiet that it makes people feel scared.)

(Confucius Institute Headquarters (Hanban), 2018d)

[34] 听说那位作家的新小说刚刚被翻译成了中文，我就买了一本。
结果发现，翻译的质量太差了，有很多地方都不符合原文，真让人失望。
(I heard that the new novel by that author was just translated into Chinese, so I bought a copy.
The result was that I found the translation quality to be very poor, with many parts differing
from the original, which was really disappointing.)

(Confucius Institute Headquarters (Hanban), 2018c)

[35] 不切实际的欲望，只会让我们感到痛苦和无奈。
(Desires that don't align with reality only make us feel sad and helpless.)

(Confucius Institute Headquarters (Hanban), 2019b)

3.2 Shi (使) is used in general contexts to indicate 1) compliance with regulations and recognition of value; 2) emotion (both positive and negative); and 3) change (Positive; Negative; neutral).

3.2.1 Compliance with regulations and recognition of value

[36] 这种新型的信号灯让一些平时讨厌等红灯的人也自愿停下脚步。
既娱乐了身心，又能锻炼身体，同时还能使人们遵守交通规则……。
(This new type of traffic light makes even those who usually dislike red lights stop walking. It
not only entertains the body and mind but also provides exercise. At the same time, it
encourages people to obey traffic rules...)

(Confucius Institute Headquarters (Hanban), 2018d)

[37] 遗憾使人懂得珍惜。
(Regret teaches people to love and cherish with appreciation.)

(Confucius Institute Headquarters (Hanban), 2019b)

3.2.2 Emotion is used in the context that emphasizes eliciting emotional responses, including both positive and negative emotions.

3.2.2.1 Positive emotions includes feeling calm, happy and relaxed

[38] 人们通过购买实物获得的幸福感更持久，因为物品在多次的使用
过程中会使人产生更多的幸福感。
(The happiness people get from shopping is lasting because the items make them feel even
happier the more they use them.)

(Confucius Institute Headquarters (Hanban), 2018d)

[39] 绿色可以使人放松并感到平静。
(Green can make people feel relaxed and calm.)

(Confucius Institute Headquarters (Hanban), 2018d)

3.2.2.2 Negative emotions

[40] 如果气温过高，不仅会使人感到身体不适，还会对人的心里和情绪生消极影响。

(If the temperature is too high, it not only makes people feel uncomfortable but also negatively affects their mind and emotions.)

(Confucius Institute Headquarters (Hanban), 2018d)

3.2.3 Changes are used in positive, negative, and neutral contexts.

3.2.3.1 Positive, such as actualizing dreams and plentiful resources.

[41] 为了使理想成真，我们应该……

(To make our desires come true, we should...)

(Confucius Institute Headquarters (Hanban), 2018c)

[42] 网络使丰富的资源触手可得……。

(The internet has made resources accessible at our fingertips...)

(Confucius Institute Headquarters (Hanban), 2019b)

3.2.3.2 Negative includes poor air quality, difficult of breathing, slippery roads, and reduced visibility.

[43] 开车一方面会带来交通问题，……；另一方面也会使空气质量变差，影响人们的健康。

(On one hand, driving causes traffic problems, ...; On the other hand, it worsens air quality and impacts people's health.)

(Confucius Institute Headquarters (Hanban), 2018c)

[44] 高温会使鱼呼吸困难。

(High temperatures make it difficult for fish to breathe.)

(Confucius Institute Headquarters (Hanban), 2018d)

[45] 驾车逃离时要注意，火山灰会使路面打滑……。

(When driving out, you must be careful. Volcanic ash can make the roads slippery...)

(Confucius Institute Headquarters (Hanban), 2019b)

[46] 此外，回南天还容易形成大雾，严重时可使能见度降至50米。

(In addition, when heading back south, thick fog can easily form. If it's severe, visibility may be reduced to as little as 50 meters.)

(Confucius Institute Headquarters (Hanban), 2018d)

3.2.3.3 Neutral includes clouds change and reduced reliance.

[47] 水汽和大气运动会使云发生各种变化。

(Water vapor and air movement can cause various changes in clouds.)

(Confucius Institute Headquarters (Hanban), 2018d)

[48] 由于风力发电机的应用，使人们逐渐减少了对煤炭的依赖。

(Due to the use of wind turbines, people have gradually reduced their reliance on coal.)

(Confucius Institute Headquarters (Hanban), 2019b)

This study further found examples that demonstrate the use of both 'rang' and 'shi', as presented in the details below:

[49] 最近，“频繁自拍容易使皮肤受损而导致早衰”的说法让不少喜欢自拍的朋友产生了担忧。

(Recently, the saying that “taking selfies frequently damages the skin and accelerates aging” has made many selfie-loving friends start to worry.)

(Confucius Institute Headquarters (Hanban), 2019b)

[50] 研究人员发现，人们在网上分享内容的主要目的是想让自己成为一个对别人有用的人。数据显示，人们似乎总是在寻找能够帮助他人、使他人感到愉悦的内容。

(Researchers have found that the main reason people share content on websites is to make themselves appear helpful to others. Statistics show that people are often looking for content that can help others, which in turn makes them feel happy.)

(Confucius Institute Headquarters (Hanban), 2019b)

This study found that 'rang' (让) focuses on oneself or other people, but 'Shi' (使) focuses on other and physique. The schematic structure analysis of usage reveals one type of visual schematics:

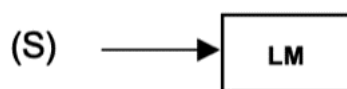


Figure 5 Image Schema of Verbs With "Causation" Meaning

(Source: Soontornthamni, 2025e)

Figure 5 shows the path that moves horizontally in a straight line toward objects. The syntactic subject can be omitted. For example [24] 为了让自己更健康，他每天都花了一个小时去锻炼身体。(To make himself stronger, he spends one hour every day exercising.), in this sentence '自己更健康 (himself stronger)' is LM [27] 李教授的突然出现让大家很激动。(The sudden appearance of Professor Li made everyone very excited.), in this sentence '大家很激动 (everyone very excited)' is LM. [41] 为了使理想成真，我们应该……(To make our desires come true, we should…), in this sentence '理想成真' is LM.

4. The Contextual Usage of Verbs Which Mean 'Invitation'

The contextual usage of verbs with the meaning of 'invitation' include 'qing (请)' and 'rang (让)'.

Table 4 Contextual Usage of Verbs With 'Invitation' Meaning

Context of Use	Vocabulary	
	qing (请)	rang (让)
1.To do some action	+	-
2.To attend	+	-
3.Asking for help and opinion	+	-

As presented in Table 4, qing (请) is used in general context, meaning inviting to do some action. The word 'qing (请)' conveys respect and honor when inviting someone. Moreover, the results of the study show that no examples were found of sentences using 'rang (让)' in this meaning as pivotal sentences.

4.1 Qing (请) is used in general contexts that focus on inviting with respect and honor. It is also used in the context of inviting someone to do an action, to attend, and to ask for help or an opinion.

4.1.1 To do an action, such as eat, drink, and come in.

[51] 我请你去吃中国菜。

(I invite you to eat Chinese food)

(Confucius Institute Headquarters (Hanban), 2018a)

4.1.2 To attend

[52] 五号是女儿的生日，她要请同学来家里玩儿。

(The fifth is his daughter's birthday. He will invite friends to come play at their house.)

(Confucius Institute Headquarters (Hanban), 2018b)

[53] 男：我想这周六请几个同学来家里吃饭。

(Man: I'm thinking of inviting two or three student friends over for dinner at my house this Saturday.)

(Confucius Institute Headquarters (Hanban), 2019a)

4.1.3 Asking for help and for opinion

[54] 每年新茶上市时，舒遵刚都会请一些工人为他择茶。

(Every year, when the new tea hits the market, Su Jungang invites some workers to select tea for him.)

(Confucius Institute Headquarters (Hanban), 2018d)

[55] “.....现在我请他们提供意见，然后再根据他们的意见修改图案。”

(...Now, I ask them for their opinions and then adjust the designs based on their suggestions.”)

(Confucius Institute Headquarters (Hanban), 2019b)

The Schematic structure analysis of usage reveals one type of visual schematics as illustrated below:



Figure 6 Image Schema of Verbs With “Invitation” Meaning

(Source: Soontornthamni, 2025f)

Figure 6 shows the path that moves horizontally in a straight line toward objects. The syntactic subject can be omitted. For example, in [51] 我请你去吃中国菜。(I invite you to eat Chinese food), ‘我 (I)’ functions as the subject (S), ‘你(you)’ functions as the object of first verb phrase and at the same time serves as the subject of the second verb phrase. In addition, ‘去吃中国菜(to eat Chinese food)’ is .

Conclusion and Discussion

1. Conclusion

This study analysis was based on schema theory and ICMs concept. The data from HSK test was analyzed. The findings addressed the research question: How do Chinese words with shared meaning differ in their contextual usage? The results indicated that the Chinese verbs with shared meanings were grouped into the same semantic category, but these words have different schematic usage structures.

The study found the contextual usage of each word, including:

(1) The contextual usage of verbs with ‘causing someone to do something’ meaning, include ‘gei (给)’ ‘jiao (叫)’ ‘qing (请)’ ‘rang (让)’ and ‘shi (使)’. These verbs are used in general contexts and service contexts. Specifically, ‘qing (请)’ is employed to politely request or notify someone to perform an action, often used in formal language, and is commonly used in business and aviation service contexts. In contrast, ‘rang (让)’ is used in commands or requests made by individuals with higher authority, such as seniors or medical professionals; ‘shi (使)’ is focused on assignment.

(2) The contextual usage of verbs with ‘granting permission’ meaning, include ‘gei (给)’ ‘jiao (叫)’ ‘rang (让)’. These verbs are predominantly used in work and medical treatment contexts; ‘gei (给)’ focuses on work leave and rest; ‘rang (给)’ is predominantly used in work and medical treatment contexts.

(3) The contextual usage of verbs with ‘causation’ meaning, include ‘rang (让)’ and ‘shi (使)’. These verbs are used in general contexts to indicate clearly and concretely defined context, such as health, knowledge, and movement. In addition, both of them are used in the contexts which cause emotions (both positive and negative), but the context of ‘shi’ is broader. It can be used in causing change, and more specific to causing physical effects.

(4) The contextual usage of verbs with ‘invitation’ meaning, include ‘qing (请)’ and ‘rang (让)’. The word ‘qing (请)’ is used in general contexts and conveys respect and courtesy when inviting someone.

This study found that some words can be used in the same contexts and situations, but they might emphasize different orientations. The theoretical significance of the research findings is that using schema theory, ICMs to analyze contextual usage of words, can be helpful to clearly visualize the sentence structure, highlight its prominence and focal points, as well as certain vocabulary words. In addition, the words grouped under different semantic categories might have the same image schema. To sum up, this study found that five Chinese confusing verbs have four types of ICMs:

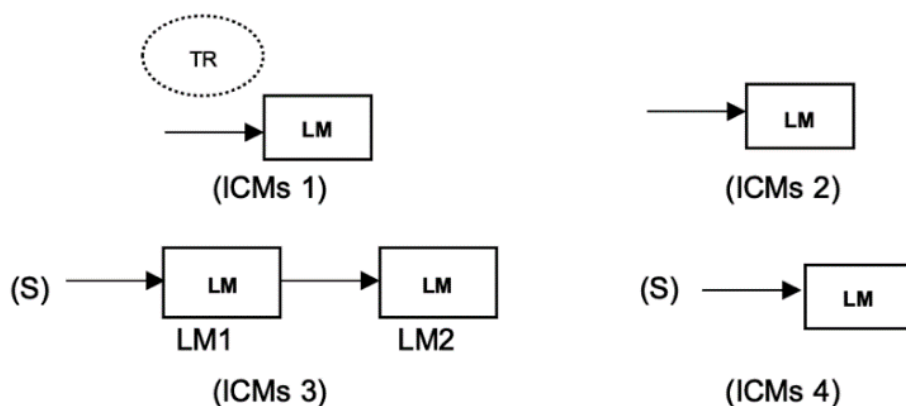


Figure 7 Image Schema of Five Chinese Verbs

(Source: Soontornthamni, 2025g)

2. Discussion

This study aimed to investigate the contextual usage of five Chinese verbs. The findings reveal that some words are used in the same context while others are used in different contexts. The contextual usage analysis, employs an image schema that summarizes the contextual structure of vocabulary usage, highlighting sentence structure, key features, and focal points for more precise understanding of how the words are used.

These findings align with cognitive linguistics theory, as Arunmanakul (2020) stated that schema is the foundation for creating meaning and understanding complex concept. Frame semantics help to understand the meaning of words clearly. In addition, this study supports the concept that cognitive grammar does not have a strict separation between the lexicon and syntax, nor a clear boundary between vocabulary and grammar. Grammatical structure is related to and stimulated by meaning.

This study extends Urapeepatanapong's (2024) schema-based analysis of Chinese word 'Qian (前)', and 'Hou (后)'. This study found that although there are only four categories of shared meanings, the contextual usage of each word has its prominence and focal points. Interestingly, this study takes a broader vision to analyze the data. Additionally, it takes the 'subject' of the sentence to describe the image schema. This study aligns with Zhang (2024) who studied the words 'kanwang (看望)' (visiting) and 'fangwen (访问)' (calling), finding that these two words are employed in scenarios like business transaction, and daily communication. However, due to the differences among the words being studied, the contexts in which they were used were also found to differ accordingly.

To summarize, the image schema found helps to understand the meaning of words in the sentences more clearly. The position of subject can help identify the subject's perspective or orientation, thus some subjects in sentences can be omitted. However, although the image schema of each word may differ, this study found that the image schema remains consistent to some extent.

3. Implications of the Findings

3.1 Pedagogical Implications

These results highlight benefits for practical implications. This study helps CFL learners understand and correctly use Chinese confusable words. CFL lecturers should not only teach meaning of the vocabulary, but also emphasize its contextual usage, especially the words which share similar meanings with the words students have learned. Lecturers should explain the differences. In addition, using conceptual image to help students understand and learn context of words can enhance their communication skills.

3.2 Theoretical Implications

The study refines image schema as a basic cognitive framework that helps reveal more specific analytical perspectives and enhances understanding of sentence-level processing.

Acknowledgments

This research was supported by a research grant from the Faculty of Liberal Arts, Prince of Songkla University, under the Research fund (Contract No. LIA6604006S-0). The author would like to express sincere gratitude for the valuable support.

References

- Ampala, P. (2016). *'Time' conceptual systems of Northern Thailand dialect speakers*. Doctoral Dissertation, Ph.D. in Linguistics, Thammasat University, Thailand. (In Thai)
- Arunmanakul, W. (2020). *Science of Language: History and Development* [Unpublished manuscript]. Bangkok: Faculty of Arts, Chulalongkorn University. (In Thai)
- Confucius Institute Headquarters (Hanban). (2018a). *Official Examination Paper of HSK (Level 1)*. Beijing: People's Education Press. (In Chinese)
- Confucius Institute Headquarters (Hanban). (2018b). *Official Examination Paper of HSK (Level 2)*. Beijing: People's Education Press. (In Chinese)
- Confucius Institute Headquarters (Hanban). (2018c). *Official Examination Paper of HSK (Level 4)*. Beijing: People's Education Press. (In Chinese)
- Confucius Institute Headquarters (Hanban). (2018d). *Official Examination Paper of HSK (Level 5)*. Beijing: People's Education Press. (In Chinese)
- Confucius Institute Headquarters (Hanban). (2019a). *Official Examination Paper of HSK (Level 3)*. 3rd ed. Beijing: People's Education Press. (In Chinese)
- Confucius Institute Headquarters (Hanban). (2019b). *Official Examination Paper of HSK (Level 6)*. 3rd ed. Beijing: People's Education Press. (In Chinese)
- Institute of Linguistics. (2021). *Contemporary Chinese Dictionary (Xiandai Hanyu Cidian) (7th Edition)*. 735th ed. Beijing: The Commercial Press. (In Chinese)
- Johnwick. (2024). *Contextual Dynamics: A Linguistic Analysis of Word usage in Sentences*. Retrieved 18 May 2025, from <https://medium.com/@biowick/contextual-dynamics-a-linguistic-analysis-of-word-usage-in-sentences-33def9912093>

- Lai, L. (2018). *The Study on Chinese Confusable Words in Thai Students*. Doctoral Dissertation, Ph.D. in International Chinese Language Education, Minzu University of China, China. (In Chinese)
- Lakoff, G. (1987). *Woman, Fire, and Dangerous Things: What Categories Reveal About the Mind*. Chicago: University of Chicago Press.
- Lakoff, G. (1988). Cognitive Semantics. In Eco, U., Santambrogio, M., & Violi, P. (Eds.) *Meaning and Mental Representations* (pp. 119-154). Bloomington: Indiana University Press.
- Oakley, T. (2012). Image Schemas. In Geeraerts, D. & Cuyckens, H. (Eds.), *The Oxford Handbook of Cognitive Linguistics* (pp. 214-235). Oxford: Oxford University Press.
- Samita, F., Supardi, I., & Husin, S. (2015). The Use of Contextual Analysis in Teaching Vocabulary. *Jurnal Untan*, 4(2), 1-11. <https://doi.org/10.26418/jppk.v4i2.9120>
- Sirisumpan, S., & Saralamba, C. (2021). The Meanings of Qi in Mandarin Chinese in Factive Motion Events. *Journal of Language and Linguistics*, 39(2), 1-30. (In Thai)
- Soontornthamniti, N. (2024). Meanings and Categories of Confusing Chinese Verbs “gei (给)” “jiao (叫)” “qing (请)” “rang (让)” “shi (使)”: A Semantic Analysis. *Journal of Arts and Thai Studies*, 46(1), 1-14. (In Thai)
- Soontornthamniti, N. (2025a). Figure 1 *Research Framework*.
- Soontornthamniti, N. (2025b). Figure 2 *Research Flow*.
- Soontornthamniti, N. (2025c). Figure 3 *Image Schema of Verbs With “Causing Someone to Do Something” Meaning*.
- Soontornthamniti, N. (2025d). Figure 4 *Image Schema of Verbs With “Granting Permission” Meaning*.
- Soontornthamniti, N. (2025e). Figure 5 *Image Schema of Verbs With “Causation” Meaning*.
- Soontornthamniti, N. (2025f). Figure 6 *Image Schema of Verbs With “Invitation” Meaning*.
- Soontornthamniti, N. (2025g). Figure 7 *Image Schema of Five Chinese Verbs*.
- Tangpakorn, B. (2018). An Application of Cognitive Semantics of Chinese Polysemy Teaching for Thai Learners. *Journal of Humanities and Social Sciences Mahasarakham University*, 37(1), 75-87. (In Thai)
- Urapeepatanapong, O. (2024). Time Metaphors of Local Words Qian and Hou in Mandarin Chinese and Thai. *Journal of Sinology*, 18(1), 182-197. (In Chinese)
- Xiao, P. (2008). *The Research on Confusable Words of Indonesian Students in Chinese Interlanguage*. Doctoral Dissertation, Ph.D. in Linguistics and Applied Linguistics, Beijing Language and Culture University, China. (In Chinese)
- Zhang, B. (2008). Compiling Principles and Style Designing of Export-Oriented Dictionaries of Confusable Words. *Chinese Language Learning*, 2(1), 85. (In Chinese)
- Zhang, B. (2016). *Butong Muyu Beijing de Hanyu Xuexizhe Ciyu Hunxiao Fenbu Tezheng Jiqi Chengyin Yanjiu*. [A Study on the Distribution Patterns and Causes of Lexical Confusion among Chinese Language Learners with Different Native Language Backgrounds]. Beijing: Peking University Press. (In Chinese)
- Zhang, D. (2024). A Corpus-Based Study on Confusable Words in the Visiting and Calling Word Category. *Communications in Humanities Research*, 27(1), 209-220.